

translucent elements: on startup and under normal use, the entire taskbar remains translucent, showing you the Desktop in the background. This behaviour changes when an application is maximised, when the taskbar becomes completely visible. The translucency also extends to the Start Menu (or the Orb menu, if you will)—one can just make out the background window, slightly blurred, or the Desktop when the menu is triggered. Some amount of animation is also used on the



The all new Windows Clock

Start Menu, particularly for the area where Vista shows the user's display picture. This user icon animates to show iconic representations of the user's documents folder, the pictures folder, his or her computer, and so on.

Other major changes have been made to the system clock and the volume control, both of which reside in the tray of the Vista taskbar. The system clock *finally* displays a calendar view when clicked, along with an analogue clock showing the time. The calendar allows you to browse through months, one at a time, or to zoom out to a month view, a year view, and a decade view, if you so wish. The clock can also display information from two other time zones, and is synced once per day to an Internet clock—a boon for the travellers.



Change the volume for individual applications

The volume control is now capable of offering